

PassportSahayak AI

Knowledge Base Document

Appointments, Fees & PSK Visit

Appointment Booking, Rescheduling, PSK Counter Flow, Fee Payment & No-Show Policy

Document Code	KB-PASS-004
Version	v1.0
Category	Appointment & PSK Operations
Audience	Applicant, Official (PSK)
Effective Date	01-April-2024
Review Frequency	Annual (or when policy changes)
Approved By	PSK Operations Leadership & Legal
Classification	Confidential — PSK/RPO Internal Use Only
KB Ingestion Tags	doc_type=appointment, audience=applicant official, version=v1.0

1. Purpose & Scope

This document defines the appointment booking process, fee payment procedure, PSK visit workflow, rescheduling and cancellation rules, and the no-show policy under the Passport Seva Programme. It serves as the reference for applicants booking appointments and for PSK counter officials managing daily queue flow.

2. Appointment Booking Process

2.1 Online Booking (Mandatory Channel)

All PSK appointments must be booked through the Passport Seva Portal (passportindia.gov.in). Walk-in appointments are not available at PSK centres; limited walk-in slots are available at POPSK centres for select services.

Step	Action	Notes
1	Register on Passport Seva Portal	Mobile OTP + email verification required; one account per applicant
2	Select service type	Fresh / Re-issue / Police Clearance Certificate
3	Fill online application form	Auto-save enabled; ARN generated on submission
4	Pay fee online	Debit/credit card, UPI, net banking; cash not accepted
5	Select PSK / POPSK location	Choose nearest centre; slot availability shown in real time
6	Select appointment date and time slot	Normal and Tatkal slots displayed separately
7	Confirm appointment	Confirmation SMS + email with ARN and appointment details
8	Print appointment confirmation	Mandatory — must be carried to PSK on visit day

2.2 Live Slot Availability — AppointmentBookingTool

The AppointmentBookingTool queries the Passport Seva Portal in real time for slot availability by PSK location, date, and category (Normal/Tatkal).

Query Type	Tool Behaviour / Output
Available Normal slots at a PSK for a given date	Returns slot count and earliest available date
Available Tatkal slots at a PSK	Returns Tatkal-specific slot count (limited to 10–15% of daily capacity)
Nearest PSK with earliest slot	Returns ranked list of PSKs by earliest available appointment date
Current queue capacity for today (Official query)	Returns current queue status — used for walk-in POPSK management
POPSK slot availability	Returns POPSK availability (limited services: re-issue/renewal only for most POPSKs)

2.3 Rescheduling & Cancellation

Parameter	Rule / Detail
Rescheduling — Permitted	Up to 2 times before the appointment date, via Passport Seva Portal
Rescheduling — Cut-off	Must be done at least 3 working days before the original appointment date
Rescheduling Fee	No fee for first reschedule; Rs.100 fee for second reschedule
Cancellation — Permitted	Applicant may cancel via Portal up to 3 working days before appointment
Cancellation — Fee Refund	Application fee is NON-REFUNDABLE once appointment is confirmed and fee paid
Fee Transfer on Reschedule	Paid fee is transferred to new appointment automatically
Tatkal Cancellation	Tatkal surcharge (Rs.2,000) is non-refundable under all circumstances

2.4 No-Show Policy

Scenario	Consequence
Applicant does not appear at PSK on appointment date	No-show recorded; appointment cancelled; fee forfeited
Fee refund for no-show	No refund — application fee is forfeited entirely
Re-booking after no-show	Applicant must re-apply and pay full fee again
Medical emergency no-show	Applicant may contact PSK within 24 hours with medical certificate; PSK Manager may allow re-booking without fresh fee at discretion
Repeated no-shows (3 or more)	Account flagged; RPO may require in-person appearance at RPO for subsequent bookings

3. PSK Counter Visit Flow

The following is the standard process flow for an applicant's visit to a Passport Seva Kendra. A typical PSK visit takes 45–90 minutes from arrival to exit.

Counter	Activity	Duration
Token (A)	Appointment confirmation check; ARN and appointment letter verified; token issued	3–5 min
Document Verification (B)	Original documents verified against application; self-attested copies collected	15–20 min
Data Verification (C)	Application data verified on screen; applicant confirms details	8–10 min
Biometrics (D)	Photograph captured; fingerprints taken (4+4+2 thumbs); signature captured	8–12 min
Supervisor (E)	Final review; documents stamped; receipt issued; applicant informed of PV type and timeline	5–10 min
Exit	Applicant exits with receipt; original documents returned	—

WHAT TO CARRY TO PSK: (1) Printed appointment confirmation letter, (2) Original documents as per KB-PASS-002 checklist, (3) Self-attested photocopies of all documents, (4) ARN printout from Passport Seva Portal, (5) Applicable annexures.

3.2 Counter Rejection — Common Reasons

- Document mismatch between application data and physical documents
- Incomplete documents (missing mandatory annexure or supporting document)
- Photograph not meeting specification (non-white background, sunglasses, hat/cap)
- Tatkal supporting document absent or not verifiable
- Application form errors (DOB mismatch, address inconsistency)

Note: If rejected at counter, the applicant receives a rejection memo specifying the reason. The appointment fee is forfeited. The applicant must correct the issue and book a fresh appointment.

4. Post-Visit — Passport Dispatch

Scenario	Dispatch Timeline	Delivery Method
Normal — Post-PV	After PV clearance (up to 30 working days from PSK visit)	Speed Post to registered address
Normal — Pre-PV	After PV clearance (up to 30 working days from PV dispatch date)	Speed Post to registered address

Scenario	Dispatch Timeline	Delivery Method
Tatkal — Post-PV	Within 3 working days of PSK visit	Speed Post to registered address
PV-Exempt	Within 7 working days of PSK visit	Speed Post to registered address
Status Tracking	Via ApplicationStatusTool using ARN; or Speed Post tracking number	—

5. POPSK — Post Office Passport Seva Kendra

POPSKs are passport service centres in post offices, providing limited passport services in tier-2 and tier-3 cities.

Feature	PSK	POPSK
Location	Major cities / district headquarters	Post offices in smaller towns
Services Available	All passport services	Re-issue/renewal; limited fresh applications
Appointment Booking	Mandatory online	Online + limited walk-in slots
Biometric Capture	Yes — full biometrics	Yes — full biometrics
Daily Capacity	50–200 tokens/day	20–50 tokens/day
PV Processing	Via RPO	Via RPO (same process as PSK)

6. Document Control

Document Owner	Passport Seva Operations Team
Review Cycle	Annual — reviewed every April
Last Reviewed	April 2024
Next Review	April 2025
Version History	v1.0 (April 2024 — Initial release for PassportSahayak AI KB)
Change Request	Submit PSK-CHG-001 to RPO Operations; approved by Joint Secretary CPV